



Good conductors

If you heat a solid, its molecules jostle around, passing the heat from molecule to molecule. Just as a whisper moves along a line of children, so the moving molecules pass, or conduct, the heat to the one end of the solid to the other.

As the water reaches its boiling point, it evaporates into steam.

When the water near the heat source gets hot, it rises up toward the surface.

The cooler water near the surface will sink to the bottom of the pan, where it is then warmed up by the heat source.



The flames are a direct source of heat.

Metal is a good conductor of heat.



Building bridges

When most solids are heated, they get bigger, or expand. This is because the heat speeds up the molecules, and they get farther and farther apart as they move. Bridges are built with small gaps between the sections of the roadway, so there is room for them to expand on a hot day.

Familiar temperatures

